

Offline Facebook

Now create personalised business cards based on images and posts from your profile's timeline



XQD Memory cards unveiled

Sony launched the world's first XQD memory cards boasting read/write speeds of upto 125MBps

Bazaar

Apple Mac mini

Style finally meets performance

While the Cupertino-based company dazzles the tech world with iPhones, iPads and MacBook Airs, the Mac mini seems to be the forgotten child in Apple's product portfolio. Still with the latest revision of the most inexpensive Mac ever, the mini boasts of improved performance thanks to Intel's second-gen Sandy Bridge Core i5 processor and a Thunderbolt I/O port at the back. Its uni-

body single-block aluminium design is much the same as its predecessor, the Mac mini looks so simple yet so elegant on the desk—not to forget its tiny, solid, and compact form factor.

In terms of bundled features, there are two main talking points. First, there's no optical drive on or bundled with the Mac mini — with Apple allowing Lion re-install through recovery partition and USB sticks. But yes, you'll need an external DVD writer to

install an older program, which adds to the cost. Also the entry-level Mac mini comes with the Mac mini's hood to access its RAM and Wi-Fi modules— it is quite easy—anything more requires a screwdriver and a lot of patience.

The Core i5 processor and AMD Radeon HD 6630M graphics ensures high performance on the new Mac mini, with multi-threaded apps and casual 3D games running just fine, it does tend to get heated up though. It's a great HTPC box as well, given the number of connectivity ports on the back. As far as mini PCs go, the Mac mini deserves consideration.

Jayesh Shinde

Specifications

CPU: Intel Core i5-2520M 2.3 GHz; **RAM:** 2 GB DDR3; **HDD:** 500 GB; **GPU:** AMD Radeon D 6630M; **Dimension:** 7.7-inch-by-1.4-inch; **USB:** 4; **HDMI,** Thunderbolt, Card reader, FireWire 800, Headphone, Microphone; **Optical drive:** No; **OS:** Mac OS X 10.7 Lion

Contact

Apple India

Phone: 18004254646

Website: www.apple.com/in

Price: ₹33,990



7.0/10

Features	6.5
Performance.....	7.0
Build Quality	8.0
Value for Money	6.5

Canon Legria HF R205

An affordable camcorder, with HD capability

Specifications

Image Sensor: 1/4.85-inch HD CMOS sensor, approx. 3.28 megapixels; **Zoom:** 18x optical; **Max video resolution:** 1920 x 1080 pixels; **Memory:** SD card; **Display:** 3-inch; **HDMI out:** Yes

Contact

Canon India

Phone: (city code) 39010101

Email: www.canon.co.in

Price: ₹19,995

Camcorders did take a back seat because most smartphones were also doing what the camcorder did as a standalone device. However, it is true that the smartphone's video recording capabilities are severely restricted, in terms of features and quality. The fight-back has begun with the affordable camcorders - the Legria HF R205 is one such device.

It has a 1/4.85-inch HD CMOS sensor, shooting at approx. 3.28 megapixels with 18x zoom. The 3-inch display is a touchscreen. Menu navigation is a bit of a pain and seemingly you can't access settings quickly, or make changes swiftly and get on with the clicking.

We must say that the videos are quite rich in terms of colour and crispness. Subject details are fully visible, and the HF R205 will

do all this in 1080p HD. However, Electronic Video/ Image stabilization is a huge drawback - it just doesn't seem to work. Unless you have a very steady hand there will be considerable amount of shake. The problem is even worse if you have zoomed to focus onto a distant object.

There is no built-in storage on the Legria HF R 205, but Canon ships it with an 8GB SD card.

For just under ₹20k, you could consider this if you can handle the annoying menu. Or consider spending a little more and go for the Sony HDR-CX130E/R, with much better image stabilization as well.

Vishal Mathur



6.0/10

Features	6.5
Performance.....	6.0
Build Quality	7.5
Value for Money	6.0